

- Home
- Announcements
- Units
- Discussions
- Assignments
- Grades
- People
- Collaborations
- Chat
- Panopto
- Panopto Timetable

Interim Progress Report (IPR)

Due: Mon, 20 Jul 2026 16:00

Attempt 1

NEXT UP: Review Feedback

100 Points Possible

Offline Score: N/A

Add Comment

3 Attempts Allowed

Available: 23 Jun 2026 0:00 until 25 Jul 2026 23:59

Details

Interim Progress Report (IPR) 10%

By the time you submit your Interim Progress Report (IPR), you should have completed approximately 280-300 hours of work on your project. This means you are nearly halfway through and should have made substantial progress in both your practical investigation and background research. The IPR is your opportunity to present a detailed written account of your progress to date, aimed at a technically proficient reader unfamiliar with your project (e.g., an independent, second marker).

Your report should clearly explain the work you have completed so far, the rationale behind your approach, and any challenges or issues you have encountered. It is essential that the report is structured coherently, with a continuous numbering system throughout, and includes supporting evidence such as screenshots or source code, which should be included in the appendices.

The IPR constitutes 10% of your overall grade and is part of the 80% coursework component as outlined in the DMD. Your work will be assessed based on the quality of your project, the scope and standard of the practical work completed, as well as the clarity and presentation of your report.

Ensure that you submit your report exclusively through Canvas, and note that you will receive feedback from your supervisor following your submission and review. In addition to the outlined submission requirements and report structure shown below, for further guidance on your report, refer to the module handbook.

Why is this a valuable opportunity?

The Interim Project Report is a valuable opportunity to assess and reflect on your progress at the midpoint of your project. It enables you to identify challenges early, allowing for necessary adjustments before submitting your Final Project Report. More importantly, it provides structured feedback from your supervisor, offering guidance on your academic writing and possible later areas of improvement. Additionally, it serves as a focal point for you to organise your work, ensuring you're on track, while reinforcing key research and project management skills.

What type of feedback will I receive?

In addition to your grade, you will receive written feedback through Canvas and/or verbal feedback during your project review and progress meetings with your supervisor.

Please note, you can reuse and further refine parts of your Detailed Project Proposal (DPP) in this document - and later, further improve and reuse parts of your Interim Progress Report (IPR) in your final report. Please note, reusing parts of your DPP and IPR that have not been updated, modified, refined or improved must be referenced and may not be of suitable academic quality to significantly add value; consult your supervisor if in doubt or to discuss the issue further.

Submission Requirements

You are required to submit one file:

- Your Interim Progress Report (including appendices).

Although there is no constraint, a structured IPR is expected to be between 8-14 pages (this includes a cover page, all sections, references and appendices). Before submitting your report, combine it and any related documents into a single document (file).

This submission assesses the DMD module learning outcomes, for more information see **Units > Project Module DMDs**.

Important: File Naming

Name your report using your student registration number followed by your name and IPR (e.g., 12003456-John-Smith IPR.docx). Acceptable file formats are Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx/.rtf), OpenOffice Text (.odt/.rtf) and Google Docs (.rtf) or Portable Document Format (.pdf). Your Interim Progress Report (IPR) is an online submission **only**.

Important Your mark will be affected if you do not follow or meet the submission and report requirements.

Report Requirements and Structure

You are strongly encouraged to use and maintain the overall sections outlined below, as they align with the markers' expectations. The breakdown within each section is provided for guidance and signposting. However, as the author, researcher, and project owner, you are free to adopt, adapt, extend, or disregard any or all of the suggested points. These recommendations are designed to help you prepare, plan, and maximise the academic and professional value of this significant piece of work.

Cover Page

- Your project's title
- Your module's title
- Your student number & name
- Your supervisor's name

Criteria 1: Background Research and Literature Research (max 10 marks)

This section should be 2-3 pages long, with sub-headings such as Goals, Objectives, Background Research, Start by introducing your project, explaining your goals, objectives, and main research question (and any sub-questions). Ensure these questions align with your project's goals and address the theoretical problem or challenge you're tackling. Your objectives should be specific, measurable, and linked to the theoretical outcomes you aim to achieve.

Provide a concise review of the relevant research you've conducted, focusing on key theories and academic frameworks. Explain how this research connects to your project and shapes both your current and planned work. Rather than listing many sources, critically analyse a few important studies (e.g., three or four) and demonstrate how they guide your theoretical approach. Discuss contrasting viewpoints or theories, and explain how your project builds on or differs from these ideas.

In addition, include examples of practical research to show how technical issues were resolved in your project. For instance, discuss how you applied certain methodologies or frameworks from the literature to address specific technical challenges. Highlight how the combination of theoretical research and practical problem-solving has informed your approach, providing concrete examples of how scholarly ideas translate into practical solutions.

Use this section to establish a strong foundation for both the theoretical and practical aspects of your project. Demonstrate how your background research supports your investigation and problem-solving, ensuring that your project contributes to both academic knowledge and practical applications. This balance will show how your work builds on theory while also resolving real-world technical challenges.

Criteria 2: Summary of Progress to Date (max 20 marks)

This section should be 2-3 pages long and clearly outline the progress you've made so far, directly linking it to your project's goals. Highlight completed tasks, such as literature review, defining requirements, creating

datasets, building prototypes, or initial testing, and explain how they align with your objectives. Detail practical work initiated, such as software development, dataset creation, or model building. Describe the tools and technologies you're using, like Python for data analysis or Jenkins for testing, and justify why these are suitable for your project.

List specific deliverables, such as design documents, codebases, software prototypes, or test plans, and provide evidence of your progress, like screenshots, code snippets, or test logs. Reference these in the appendices. If you've encountered challenges, such as technical issues or unclear requirements, explain how you've handled them. Outline your project management approach, perhaps using a structured timeline for key milestones while maintaining flexibility for iterative development and testing. This section should clearly show measurable progress and your strategy for project completion.

Criteria 3: Consideration of Ethical, Legal, Professional, and Social Issues (max 20 marks)

As part of either your introduction or background research, you need a few paragraphs, reviewing the ethical, legal, professional, and social issues related to your project. Start by stating whether ethics approval is required, and provide a clear reason for your decision. Reflect on how this affects your research process.

Consider the current scope of your project while also thinking about how these issues could evolve if the project is further developed. Ethically, ensure your project respects privacy, avoids harm, and promotes fairness. Think about whether your methods might violate privacy standards and how you'll manage these risks. Consider how these concerns might change if your project grows. Legally, make sure you comply with data protection laws like GDPR and respect intellectual property rights. Reflect on how handling sensitive data could become more complex if the project expands. Professionally, follow industry standards to ensure high-quality work and accountability. Think about how these practices support your project now and in future development. Socially, consider your project's impact on privacy, equality, or accessibility. For example, could your project create bias or promote inclusivity? Reflect on how these effects might grow with further development.

By discussing and reflecting on these issues now and in a possible future, you show awareness of your project's broader impact and will help add depth and academic value to your work.

Criteria 4: Project Plan (max 15 marks)

This section should be 1-2 pages long. Explain your project management approach and discuss how (e.g., if you've adopted a hybrid method) aspects such as managing scope, time, resources, challenges, risk, quality, adjusting priorities, meetings, feedback, and report writing stays focused, on schedule, and meet the expected academic and professional standards.

List the key tasks that remain, including those you've already completed supported with planned target dates for each. Explain in summary what each task involves and the deliverables it will produce. Include your strategy for evaluating the quality of your work and how you will assess the overall project process and value of your findings. Remember to schedule time for writing the final report and preparing for any presentations or demonstrations. Regardless of your management approach, a Gantt chart* is not strictly expected but some form of visualisation might be useful.

**A Gantt chart visually represents project tasks along a timeline, showing when each task starts, its duration, and what task depends on another. It helps track progress and includes key milestones, highlighting the tasks that are critical to the project's completion. These charts make it easier visualise time and monitor progress - however, they can become complicated for projects with many tasks and dependencies, they may oversimplify relationships between tasks and make handling unexpected changes more difficult (requiring the need for regular updates to stay accurate). For the purpose of this report, your Gantt chart should accurately reflect your project at the time of submission.*

Criteria 5: Level of the Project (max 15 marks)

One goal of the IPR is to assess the level of your project by focusing on the problem, research, investigation, methods, and artefact. This will be in multiple of the previous sections, this part should serve as a critical reflection on why and how your project qualifies as a valid MSc level undertaking. This includes demonstrating the depth, complexity, and rigour expected, with a strong focus on testing, validation, and experimentation.

This is the red thread that brings your whole report together. Begin by describing the challenge and why it interests you, linking it to your future career aspirations. Explain the artefact you're developing (whether software, a model, or a system) and how it addresses the problem. Reflect critically on how the work demonstrates advanced skills and/or innovation, improves or diverges from existing technologies or approaches. Next, explore the depth of your investigation. Reflect on how you have or will comprehensively explore the research problem, combining both theory and practical application. Include plans for testing and validation, and critically assess the experiments you've conducted (or plan to conduct). Consider edge cases, feasibility, and performance under different conditions to demonstrate how your project will deliver meaningful, reliable results. Finally, justify the methods and tools you are using. Critically or comparatively evaluate why they are the best fit for your project and how they enable comprehensive testing and experimentation; show how these choices contribute to the reliability and effectiveness of your overall project.

By using this guidance to critically reflect on the project's depth, complexity, and rigour, you will effectively demonstrate that your project meets the expected academic and technical standards of an MSc.

Criteria 6: Referencing and In-Text Citation (max 10 marks)

Use the Harvard referencing system consistently throughout your report, including all sources, even if they aren't directly cited. List references alphabetically by the author's surname. Ensure you use technical terms correctly and keep references relevant to your project. For in-text citations, follow Harvard guidelines by including the author's surname and publication year. Ensure all citations support your project's goals and demonstrate academic rigour. The references should reflect key studies, technical resources, and industry standards that informed your research and development. By using proper referencing and citations, you'll enhance the credibility of your work and meet the academic standards expected for an MSc-level project.

Criteria 7: Report Presentation (max 10 marks)

Ensure your report is well-organised and properly named, with each section flowing logically into the next. Write clearly and concisely, allowing each section to build naturally on the previous. Check for spelling and grammar errors to maintain professionalism and readability. Follow good academic and professional standards in structure, citations, diagrams, illustrations, and examples. Support your arguments with well-justified reasoning and rationales.

A clear, well-presented report will help demonstrate your attention to detail and professionalism and make your ideas easier to understand and thereby potentially increase your academic mark.

Appendices

Include any supporting documents as appendices. Number each appendix (e.g., Appendix 1 ..., Appendix 2 ...) and give them clear titles. Evidence provided can include designs, code snippets, test plans, or meeting records. Use the appendices to provide strong evidence of your progress, such as source code, screenshots, version control logs, or records from management tools (e.g., sprint reviews or task tracking).

IPR Marking Form

Section	Description	Max Mark
1	Background research and literature review	10
2	Summary of progress to date <i>(supported by material in the appendices)</i>	20
3	Consideration of ethical, legal, professional and social issues	20
4	Project plan <i>(supported by material in the appendices)</i>	15
5	Level of the project <i>(Level of the proposed Artefact, Level of the proposed Investigation, Appropriateness of the proposed Methods)</i>	15
6	Referencing and in-text citation	10
7	Report presentation: Report structure and coherence, Readability, grammar and spelling	10
	Total Marks Available	100

For more information see the rubric.

Additional information

- Regulations governing assessment offences including Plagiarism and Collusion are available from [Academic Integrity and Academic Misconduct UPR AS14 Appendix III - version 19.0](#) (UPR AS14).
- GenAI information

In this assessment the student **is permitted** to use GenAI tools (or a proofreader or proofreading service) to proofread their work **but not permitted** to use AI tools in the creation of content for their work. *Remember, your proofreader may not write any of the text but only gives suggestions for you and you need to declare your proofreader.*

This category will apply irrespective of the fact that the grading criteria include credit for English and grammar.

- Guidance on avoiding plagiarism can be found here:
[What is academic misconduct and how do I avoid it?](#)
- For postgraduate modules:
 - A score of 50% or above represents a pass mark.
 - Late submission of any item of coursework for each day or part thereof (or for hard copy submission only, working day or part thereof) for up to five days after the published deadline, coursework relating to modules at Level 7 submitted late (including deferred coursework, but with the exception of referred coursework), will have the numeric grade reduced by 10 grade points until or unless the numeric grade reaches or is 50. Where the numeric grade awarded for the assessment is less than 50, no lateness penalty will be applied.

View Rubric

IPR (3)									
Criteria	Ratings								Points
1. Background research and literature review	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/10 pts
	Outstanding review, concise critical review, clear linkage to the project, strong justifications 10 to >9 pts	Excellent review, concise critical review, clear linkage to the project, strong justifications 9 to >8 pts	Very good, concise review of relevant papers, some critical appraisal, set into context of project but lacking concise linkage 8 to >7 pts	Good, concise review of relevant papers, set into context of project but lacking concise linkage 7 to >6 pts	Satisfactory review, concise review of relevant papers, limited critical appraisal 6 to >5 pts	Limited review, overview of few relevant papers with no critical appraisal 5 to >4 pts	Limited review, overview of few relevant papers with no critical appraisal 4 to >2 pts	Limited review, overview of few relevant papers with no critical appraisal 2 to >0 pts	
2. Summary of progress to date (supported by material in the appendices)	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/20 pts
	Outstanding summary of progress, substantial implementation work 20 to >18 pts	Excellent summary of progress, substantial implementation work 18 to >16 pts	Very good summary of progress, some implementation of work evidenced 16 to >14 pts	Good summary of progress, some implementation of work 14 to >12 pts	Satisfactory summary of progress, some implementation work completed 12 to >10 pts	Clear evidence of some progress but too little, some implementation work completed 10 to >8 pts	Inconsistent, some evidence of progress but lacking continuity 8 to >4 pts	Little or no evidence of progress 4 to >0 pts	
3. Consideration of ethical, legal, professional and social issues	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/20 pts
	Outstanding consideration of legal/ professional/social issues, and knowledge of University procedures in relation to ethics approval demonstrated 20 to >18 pts	Excellent consideration of legal/ professional/social issues, and knowledge of University procedures in relation to ethics approval demonstrated 18 to >16 pts	Very good consideration of legal/ professional/social issues. Some awareness of University procedures in relation to ethics approval demonstrated 16 to >14 pts	Good consideration of legal/ professional/social issues. Some awareness of University procedures in relation to ethics approval demonstrated 14 to >12 pts	Most but not all ethical/ legal/ professional/social issues considered. Consideration of Ethics approval touched on. 12 to >10 pts	Some ethical/ legal/ professional/social issues considered but quite lacking 10 to >8 pts	Naïve/superficial consideration of ethical/ legal/ professional/social issues 8 to >4 pts	Little or no consideration of ethical/ legal/ professional/social issues 4 to >0 pts	
4. Project plan (supported by material in the appendices)	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/15 pts
	Outstanding, concise and coherent project plan with clearly defined tasks and timelines 15 to >13.5 pts	Excellent, concise and coherent project plan. Clearly defined tasks and timelines with minor errors 13.5 to >12 pts	Concise and coherent project plan. Some clearly defined tasks, and other rather vague tasks. Clearly defined timeline with minor errors. 12 to >10.5 pts	Concise and coherent project plan. Some clearly defined tasks, and other rather vague tasks. Clear timelines with minor errors or vagueness 10.5 to >9 pts	Satisfactory, concise and coherent project planning with some defined tasks and timelines 9 to >7.5 pts	Some project planning with loosely defined tasks and timelines, feasibility of the plan questionable 7.5 to >6 pts	Some evidence of project planning but too vague and likely unfeasible 6 to >3 pts	Little or no evidence of project planning 3 to >0 pts	
5. Level of the project (Level of the proposed Artefact, Level of the proposed Investigation, Appropriateness of the proposed Methods)	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/15 pts
	Outstanding level of the proposed artefact and investigation with well-thought-through methods. 15 to >13.5 pts	Excellent level of the proposed artefact and investigation with well-thought-through methods. Or very high level of artefact and investigation with slightly unfit methods. 13.5 to >12 pts	Very good level of the proposed artefact and investigation with well-thought-through methods. Or high level of artefact and investigation with some unfit methods. 12 to >10.5 pts	Good level of the proposed artefact and investigation with well-thought-through methods. Or a good level of artefact and investigation with unfit methods. 10.5 to >9 pts	Proposed artefact and investigation meet the MSc level. The proposed methods are appropriate. 9 to >7.5 pts	Proposed artefact and investigation are not at an MSc level but close. The proposed methods are not fit for purpose. 7.5 to >6 pts	Proposed artefact and investigation are not at an MSc level. The proposed methods are not fit for purpose. 6 to >3 pts	Little or no evidence of the proposed artefact, investigation, and used methods. 3 to >0 pts	
6. Referencing and in-text citation	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/10 pts
	Outstanding referencing, in-text citations and use of technical terms 10 to >9 pts	Excellent referencing and use of technical terms, well placed and correct in-text citations 9 to >8 pts	Very good use of referencing and technical terms, occasional mistakes, largely correct in-text citations 8 to >7 pts	Good use of referencing and technical terms, occasional mistakes, largely correct in-text citations 7 to >6 pts	Satisfactory referencing and use of technical terms, minor mistakes, in-text citations used throughout 6 to >5 pts	Some correct referencing, in-text citations and use of technical terms, frequent mistakes 5 to >4 pts	Incomplete referencing, in-text citations and use of technical terms, frequent mistakes 4 to >2 pts	Little or no coherent referencing and use of technical terms 2 to >0 pts	
7. Report presentation: Report structure and coherence, Readability, grammar and spelling	Outstanding	Excellent	Very Good	Good	Clear Pass	Marginal Fail	Clear Fail	Nothing of Merit	/10 pts
	Outstanding standard of production, report set out in clear and attractive format. No grammar/ spelling errors. 10 to >9 pts	High standard of production, infrequent production errors, clear, high-quality and labelled figures. Very minor grammar/spelling errors. 9 to >8 pts	Very good standard of production, infrequent production errors, clear, high-quality and labelled figures. Very minor grammar/spelling errors. 8 to >7 pts	Good presentation, minor production errors, clear and labelled figures. Very minor grammar/spelling errors. 7 to >6 pts	Satisfactory presentation, minor errors in spelling/ grammar and formatting, but text conveys meaning. Figures are labelled 6 to >5 pts	Argument difficult to follow. Some errors in formatting compromising meaning and readability. Poor spelling and grammar. 5 to >4 pts	Argument difficult to follow. Patchy presentation, frequent errors in formatting compromising meaning and readability. Poor spelling and grammar. 4 to >2 pts	Very difficult to follow. Many grammar/ spelling errors. 2 to >0 pts	

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